

Seleeke Flingai, PhD, MPA

Philadelphia, PA | (612) 597-5345 | seleeke@protonmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | [Personal Website](#)

Applied policy research expert with 7+ years of experience designing and producing policy-relevant, visually rich data products and incisive policy analysis in mission-driven organizations and government agencies, with a focus in criminal legal system reform and economic justice. Track record of effective project and people management, research strategy, digestible research translation across teams and diverse audiences to inform policy, and engaging stakeholder relationship development.

EXPERIENCE

Vera Institute of Justice

Senior Research Associate, Incarceration and Inequality Project NOVEMBER 2025-PRESENT

- Conduct research scoping, quantitative analysis in R, and public communication documentation (i.e., explainers, press releases) for a burgeoning research program focused on the intersection of economic precarity and incarceration.

Senior Research Associate, Reshaping Prosecution Initiative JANUARY 2022-OCTOBER 2022

Research Associate II, Reshaping Prosecution Initiative MAY 2020-JANUARY 2022

- Led and managed three 18-month quantitative research and data transparency projects for district attorney site partners
- Built workflows using R, SQL, and Datawrapper to extract, transform, analyze, and visualize data from each office's relational database management system
- Authored public-facing written material and provided oral testimony for a public hearing to share policy-relevant research findings and advance local and national policy objectives

University of Chicago

Assistant Instructional Professor JUNE 2024-DECEMBER 2025

- Developed and taught graduate courses in introductory public health, GIS and spatial analysis (taught with R and Mapbox API), urban health, social inequalities, and public health professional development for the Master of Public Health program
- Built research scopes and managed graduate students conducting rigorous research projects, including capstone research
- Provided individualized academic and career advising to 50+ students while co-leading application review for MPH admissions

PolicyLink

Senior Associate, National Equity Atlas NOVEMBER 2022-MAY 2024

- Led research engagements with community partners and developed analyses, reports, and other data tools to support community-led struggles for economic equity; used both quantitative and qualitative (i.e. structured interviews) approaches
- Regularly maintained strong relationships with external consultants and community leaders

University of Pennsylvania

Lecturer and Senior Fellow, Perelman School of Medicine SEPTEMBER 2022-MAY 2024

- Developed and taught two iterations (Fall '22, Spring '24) of the Master of Public Health course "Race and Public Health"
- Served as a three-time guest lecturer for the Center for Public Health's annual "GIS and Public Health Institute" (2021-23)

Metropolitan Area Planning Council

Research Analyst II JUNE 2018-APRIL 2020

- Led the data analysis work for over a half dozen research efforts, with a primary focus on social vulnerability, racial and socioeconomic disparities, and residential displacement in Greater Boston. Built proficiency in R, Leaflet, and ArcGIS.
- Developed statistical clustering and classification models in R to classify housing submarkets and climate-vulnerable communities using multiple data sources; collaborated with web development team to produce online interactive maps
- Presented findings and authored policy memos and reports, research briefs, literature reviews, and technical documentation

EDUCATION

Princeton University, School of Public and International Affairs 2018
MPA, Domestic Policy (Certificate in Urban Policy and Planning)

University of Pennsylvania, Perelman School of Medicine 2016
PhD, Cell and Molecular Biology (Certificate in Public Health)

Massachusetts Institute of Technology 2011
SB, Brain and Cognitive Sciences

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: R | SQL | Python | HTML | CSS | JavaScript

Software and Data Tools: GIS (ArcGIS, QGIS, Mapbox API) | Datawrapper | Git